

Superstition

Sprint 4 Mini Textbook — Eb Dorian Modal Vamp
Stevie Wonder · ~100 BPM · Eb-F-Gb-Ab-Bb-C-Db



MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER

- **Ch.7** — Interval Spelling at Keyboard
- **Ch.8** — All 8 Clefs on Staff
- **Ch.9** — Di-Chord Numbers intro ([1]–[11])
- Pythagorean method: no formulas needed

MELODY CHAMBER

- **Duration Amplifies Zone**
- Zone 3 (4) in Dorian context
- Long note tension vs. long note resolution
- Dorian's raised 6 — sweet or bitter?

HARMONY CHAMBER

- Prog #4: **ii-V-I** as drill vehicle
- Consolidate #1–#4 across all sprints
- Prog #5 (vi-IV-I-V) preview
- Modal vamp vs. functional harmony

RHYTHM CHAMBER

- **Son Clave 2-3** orientation added
- Groove development: 4-step process
- Superstition clav pattern study
- Stops + anticipations + clave sync

VOICINGS CHAMBER

- Triad shapes by **stringset** (guitar)
- All inversions on all 4 string sets
- Beato pp. 93–100
- Piano: arpeggios + Dorian heptachord

SONG FOCUS

- Eb7 → Ab7 → Bb7 modal vamp
- Dorian raised-6 quality (C natural)
- Clav groove rhythm breakdown
- Verse groove on both instruments

Sprint 4 North Star: Feel the pull of the flat-7 (Db) and the lift of the natural-6 (C) — that tension/release is the soul of Dorian. By the end of this sprint you will be able to lock into the Superstition groove and hear exactly where each note lives.

Sprint 4 Contents

Anchor Song: *Superstition* — Stevie Wonder | Key: Eb Dorian | Tempo: ~100 BPM

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How to use this textbook: Each page corresponds to one chamber of the AMF system. Work through the Musical OS section first (it builds the vocabulary), then dive into whichever chamber matches your practice goal for the day. The Quick Reference Card on page 10 is your daily warm-up companion.

Chapter 7: Interval Spelling at the Keyboard

An **interval** is the distance between two notes. In Ch.7 you learn to identify and spell any interval using only the keyboard layout — no formulas, no counting half-steps mechanically.

THE PYTHAGOREAN METHOD (REVIEW FROM CH.6)

Arrange the seven note names in this order: **F — C — G — D — A — E — B**

- **Left = flat side** (F is the flattest). **Right = sharp side** (B is the sharpest).
- Adjacent letters in this chain share **six of seven** scale notes — they are maximally close.
- To spell an interval: find both notes on the chain. Count the steps between them. The count tells you the interval quality.
- **One step apart** = perfect fifth (or fourth, depending on direction). **Two steps apart** = major second. **Three steps** = major sixth.

Keyboard anchor rule: The two-black-key group = C (left), D (middle), E (right). The three-black-key group = F (left), G, A (middle two), B (right). Knowing this by sight lets you place any note instantly.

Sprint 4 Interval Targets

By end of sprint, identify *any* interval on the keyboard using the Pythagorean chain — no counting half-steps one by one.

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Sing the interval "F up to C" (perfect 5th). Then find F and C on the keyboard. Notice they are one step apart on the Pythagorean chain (F–C). Repeat with G–D, C–G. These are all P5ths. Recognize the sound before the name.

S2 — PERFECTING

Hear before you play. Pick any two white keys at random. Before naming the interval, sing the distance first. Then use the Pythagorean chain to confirm. Practice: Eb to Bb (P5), Eb to Ab (P4), Eb to C (maj6 = raised 6 of Dorian!).

S3 — FLUENT

Hear before you play. Teacher names any two notes. You name the interval in under 2 seconds, using only the chain. Include enharmonic pairs: Db = C# (one step to left of D on chain). Target: all diatonic intervals in Eb Dorian fluently.

Chapter 8: All 8 Clefs on the Staff

Western notation uses eight clefs to position notes on the staff. Every clef is an anchor: it fixes one specific line to a specific note, and all other notes follow from there.

 Treble G on line 2	 Bass F on line 4	B Soprano C on line 1	M-S Mezzo-Soprano C on line 2
A Alto C on line 3	T Tenor C on line 4	Bar Baritone C on line 5	X Percussion No pitch anchor

C-clef insight: The C clef (soprano, mezzo-soprano, alto, tenor, baritone) is a *movable* clef — it slides up and down the staff to place middle C wherever the range works best for the instrument. The clef symbol always marks the exact line where middle C sits.

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Look at a treble-clef staff. Sing middle C. Now imagine it sliding down to the bass clef. It sits on the first ledger line above. This is the same pitch — just notated differently. Repeat this mental shift for soprano and alto clef.

Chapter 9: Di-Chord Numbers — Introduction

Traditional interval names (minor 3rd, perfect 5th) were designed for written notation. **Di-Chord Numbers** are designed for *hearing* and *playing*. They give each interval a number [1]–[11] that describes its emotional character directly.

Di = two (from Latin *dis*). A di-chord is any two-note sound. The number captures what the interval *feels like* to the ear.

[1]
Min 2nd
Tense, urgent

[2]
Maj 2nd
Tense, stepping

[3]
Min 3rd
Modal, closed

[4]
Maj 3rd
Modal, open

[5]
P4th
Suspended

[6]
Tritone
Frozen, unstable

[7]
P5th
Stable, open

[8]
Min 6th
Closed, darker

[9]
Maj 6th
Open, bright

[10]
Min 7th
Tense, leaning

[11]
Maj 7th
Extremely tense

WHY DI-CHORD NUMBERS MATTER FOR SUPERSTITION

The Eb7 chord in Superstition contains two di-chord intervals that define its sound:

- **Eb to Db** = a [10] minor 7th. This is the "blues lean" — tense, wanting to resolve down.
- **Eb to C** = a [9] major 6th. This is the Dorian raised-6 — open, surprisingly bright for a minor chord.
- **Eb to Bb** = a [7] perfect 5th. Stable, the harmonic foundation.
- These three intervals stacked = the emotional color of the entire song groove.

Di-Chord Sprint 4 Drill: Eb Dorian Context

FROM EB TO...	DI-CHORD #	TRADITIONAL NAME	FEEL IN SUPERSTITION
F	[2]	Maj 2nd	Stepping away, mild tension
Gb	[3]	Min 3rd	Minor quality confirmed — modal, closed
Ab	[4]	Maj 3rd (+ octave = P4)	P4 = suspended lift going to IV chord
Bb	[7]	P5th	Stable foundation of Eb7
C	[9]	Maj 6th	The Dorian note — bright, jazzy surprise
Db	[10]	Min 7th	The blues lean of the dominant 7th

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Play Eb alone. Then play Eb + C together. That is a [9] major 6th. Notice the surprising brightness. Now play Eb + Db. That is a [10] minor 7th. Notice the lean, the wanting-to-move. These two intervals tell you everything about Dorian's character.

S2 — PERFECTING

Hear before you play. Name each di-chord before playing. Go through the Eb Dorian scale (Eb F Gb Ab Bb C Db) singing each interval from Eb. Match your sung interval to the number before touching the keys or strings.

S3 — FLUENT

Hear before you play. Teacher plays any two notes from Eb Dorian. You name the di-chord number within 2 seconds by ear only. Then confirm at the keyboard. No looking at the chart.

CH.9 SCOPE NOTE

This sprint introduces [1]–[11] as a vocabulary. Mastery of all eleven by ear is a longer arc — Sprint 4 exit target is recognition of the six intervals present in Eb Dorian ([2],[3],[4],[7],[9],[10]) and naming the tritone [6] as "frozen / unstable." Full Di-Chord fluency develops across Sprints 4–6.

Duration Amplifies Zone

You already know the four zones: Zone 1 (Sweet: 1, 3, 5), Zone 2 (Bitter: 7, 2), Zone 3 (Tense: 4), Zone 4 (Wildcard: 6). This sprint reveals a critical hidden dimension: **how long you hold a note changes how much tension it creates.**

THE DURATION RULE

Long note in Z1 (Sweet): Deep, settled resolution. Feels like coming home and staying. The longer you hold 1 or 5, the more grounded the phrase.

Short note in Z1: Passes through — sweet but not anchored. A quick 1 doesn't land with the same weight.

Long note in Z3 (Tense: 4): *Much* more tension. A held 4 (Ab in Eb Dorian) insists on resolution. It doesn't let the listener relax.

Short note in Z3: Passes through lightly. A quick 4 creates movement without demanding resolution.

Zone 3 in Eb Dorian Context

In Eb Dorian, the scale degree 4 = **Ab**. When Stevie Wonder's vocal line lands on Ab and holds it over an Eb7 chord, you feel the pull immediately. The longer it stays, the more the ear screams for resolution.

Dorian 4 (Ab over Eb7): This note is NOT in the Eb7 chord (Eb, Gb, Bb, Db). It sits a half step above the chord's 3rd (Gb) and a whole step below the 5th (Bb). Held long, it creates a suspended-fourth feeling. When it resolves down to Gb or up to Bb, the release is physical.

The Dorian Raised-6 (Zone 4 Wildcard)

Dorian's defining note is its **natural 6 — C natural** (not Cb as in natural minor / Aeolian). In Eb Dorian this is C. Its zone status depends entirely on context:

CONTEXT	NOTE	ZONE FEEL	QUALITY
Over Eb7 (tonic)	C (natural 6)	Z4 Wildcard	Bright, jazzy, unexpected warmth
Over Ab7 (IV chord)	C (maj3rd of Ab)	Z1 Sweet	Fully resolved, inside the chord
Held long over Eb7	C natural	Z4 leaning Z2	Dreamy tension, wants to resolve to Bb or Eb

Five Key Notes Review — Applied to Superstition

KEY NOTE	ROLE	SUPERSTITION APPLICATION
First note	Establishes zone	Often Eb (Z1) or Gb (Z1 minor 3rd) — sets minor-modal frame
Last note	Closes or continues phrase	Phrases ending on Eb = closed; ending on Db or F = open, groove continues
Highest note	Emotional peak	Peaks often on Bb (Z1 fifth) or C (Z4 Dorian note)
Longest note	Duration amplifies zone	Long Gb = settled minor. Long Ab = maximum tension (Z3)
Beat 1 note	Rhythmic anchor	Eb on beat 1 = strong landing; Gb on beat 1 = forward lean

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Listen to Superstition (0:00–0:30). Focus only on the vocal melody. Track the longest note in each phrase. What zone does it land in? Does it feel resolved or tense?

S2 — PERFECTING

Hear before you play. Sing the first verse melody on scale degree numbers (1, 3, 5, etc.) without an instrument. When you reach a long note, name its zone before continuing. Cross-check against the chord underneath.

S3 — FLUENT

Hear before you play. Improvise a 4-bar phrase over the Eb7 vamp. Deliberately use a long note in Z3 (Ab) followed by resolution to Z1 (Gb or Bb). Can you make a listener lean forward and then release? Record and listen back.

Sprint 4 Harmony Overview

Sprints 2–4 introduced four core progressions. This sprint completes the consolidation. By exit you should be able to identify and play all four on both instruments.

THE 4 PROGRESSIONS — SPRINT 4 CHECKPOINT

PROG #	NAME	FORMULA	SOUND CHARACTER	INTRODUCED
#1	I-IV-V-I	Tonic → Sub → Dom → Tonic	Fundamental cadence, complete circle	Sprint 2
#2	I-V-vi-IV	Tonic → Dom → Rel Min → Sub	"Four chord" pop universal, emotional	Sprint 2
#3	12-Bar Blues	I-I-I-I / IV-IV-I-I / V-IV-I-V	Blues foundation, cyclical, dance-floor	Sprint 3
#4	ii-V-I	ii → V7 → I	Jazz drill vehicle — tight resolution	Sprint 4

Progression #4: ii-V-I — Drill Vehicle, Not Harmonic Spine

Critical framing: ii-V-I is a *drill vehicle* — a useful exercise for practicing voice leading and jazz vocabulary. It is **one of fourteen progressions** in the AMF system, not the foundation of music. Real songs use it as a moment, not as their entire structure.

In Eb major the ii-V-I is: **Fm7 → Bb7 → Ebmaj7**. In C major: **Dm7 → G7 → Cmaj7**. In G major: **Am7 → D7 → Gmaj7**.

WHY II-V-I WORKS (MECHANICALLY)

- The **ii chord** (Fm7 in Eb) introduces the 4th scale degree (Ab) — a Zone 3 note that creates tension.
- The **V7 chord** (Bb7) contains the tritone [6] between its 3rd (D) and 7th (Ab). Tritone = frozen, must resolve.
- The **I chord** (Ebmaj7) resolves both tensions simultaneously. The tritone dissolves. Zone 3 resolves to Zone 1.
- Result: the motion from ii to V7 to I is the most efficient tension-and-release mechanism in tonal harmony.

Piano Drill: Shell Voicing ii-V-I

Shell voicing = root + 3rd + 7th only (no 5th). This is the advanced-beginner piano target for Sprint 4.

Dm7 ii in C major D + F + C	G7 V7 in C major G + B + F	Cmaj7 I in C major C + E + B	Am7 ii in G major A + C + G	D7 V7 in G major D + F# + C	Gmaj7 I in G major G + B + F#
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Modal Vamp vs. Functional Harmony

Superstition does **not** use ii-V-I as its harmonic engine. It uses a **modal vamp** — a groove that establishes a tonal center (Eb) without needing to "resolve" to it. The chord moves (Eb7 → Ab7 → Bb7) create motion and color, but there is no cadence, no resolution point. The tonic never goes away.

	FUNCTIONAL HARMONY (II-V-I)	MODAL VAMP (SUPERSTITION)
Tonic	Destination, arrived at	Home you never leave
Chords	Each chord has a role (tension/release)	Chords are color, not direction
Time feel	Drives forward toward cadence	Circular, hypnotic, groove-based
Emotion	Journey with destination	Present tense, immersive

Progression #5 Preview (Sprint 5): vi-IV-I-V — heard in "What's Going On" and hundreds of soul/R&B songs. Begins on the vi (relative minor), creates a different emotional starting point than I-V-vi-IV even though it uses the same four chords in a different order.

Eb Dorian Modal Vamp — Full Breakdown

Chord Structure

The harmony in Superstition is built on a single modal center: **Eb Dorian**. The primary progression circles through three dominant-7th chords:

Eb7
Tonic chord
Eb-Gb-Bb-Db
4 bars (verse)

Ab7
IV chord
Ab-C-Eb-Gb
Color / lift

Bb7
V chord
Bb-D-F-Ab
Maximum tension

Full progression (12-bar-adjacent, but modal):

Eb7 | Eb7 | Eb7 | Eb7

Ab7 | Ab7 | Eb7 | Eb7

Bb7 | Ab7 | Eb7 | (turnaround)

Why dominant 7ths on every chord? In Dorian, the tonic chord naturally carries a minor 7th (Db in Eb7). When this same quality extends to IV (Ab7) and V (Bb7), the music stays in one modal world without any chord functioning as a "dominant that resolves." Every chord is equally tense and equally at home. This is the Dorian paradox.

Eb Dorian Explained

DORIAN SCALE: EB-F-GB-AB-BB-C-DB

vs. Eb Natural Minor (Aeolian): Eb-F-Gb-Ab-Bb-**Cb**-Db
Dorian raises the 6th degree: Cb → C natural. That single change creates the "jazzy minor" color.

The raised 6 (C natural) creates a major 6th above Eb — di-chord [9]. Bright, unexpected. It's why Dorian sounds simultaneously minor *and* hopeful.

Mode brightness ranking (Pythagorean / Ch.6): Lydian > Ionian > Mixolydian > **Dorian** > Aeolian > Phrygian > Locrian. Dorian sits exactly in the middle — the most balanced minor mode.

Melody Zone Map — Eb Dorian

SCALE DEGREE	NOTE	ZONE	CHARACTER IN SUPERSTITION
1	Eb	Z1 Sweet	Home, settled, landing point
2	F	Z2 Bitter	Mild stepping tension
3	Gb	Z1 Sweet	Minor-quality anchor, inside Eb7
4	Ab	Z3 Tense	Suspended pull — demands resolution (esp. when held)
5	Bb	Z1 Sweet	Stable 5th, harmonic foundation
6	C	Z4 Wild	The Dorian note — bright surprise, context-dependent
7	Db	Z2 Bitter	Flat-7 blues lean, inside Eb7 chord

What to Listen For

THE CLAV GROOVE
The clavinet IS the rhythm section. Listen for the anticipations — notes that hit on the "and" of 4 (position 8 of the grid) rather than beat 1. This is what makes the groove feel like it's always leaning forward.

THE FLAT-7 (DB)
The Db in the Eb7 chord is your Zone 2 blues note. When the melody hits Db and holds it, you hear the characteristic "lean" of blues-funk. It's inside the chord but never feels fully resolved.

IV CHORD ARRIVAL
When Eb7 moves to Ab7, the C natural (Dorian raised-6) suddenly becomes the 3rd of Ab7 — fully inside the chord. Zone 4 Wildcard becomes Zone 1 Sweet. Chord changes transform a note's meaning.

Son Clave: 2-3 Orientation

In Sprint 3 you learned the **3-2 clave** — the three-side comes first. Sprint 4 adds the **2-3 orientation**, which flips the two measures. Same five notes, different starting point, completely different groove feel.

BINARY GRID REMINDER

Each measure = 8 grid positions. Odd positions (1,3,5,7) = beats. Even positions (2,4,6,8) = "ands."

3-2 CLAVE (Sprint 3 — review):



Three side: beats 1, 2, 3-and / Two side: beat 1, 2-and

2-3 CLAVE (Sprint 4 — new):



Two side first: beat 1, 2-and / Three side second: beats 1, 2, 3-and

Orientation matters: 3-2 clave front-loads the three-side and feels like it's pushing forward. 2-3 clave holds back in measure one and then surges in measure two. Superstition's clav pattern lives closer to the 2-3 feel — the first beat of the pattern is sparse, and the density builds into the second measure.

Groove Development: 4-Step Process

- 1 Boring:** Play the chord or bass note on every beat, evenly. Pure quarter notes, no swing. This establishes the harmonic rhythm before adding any groove. Play Eb7 quarter notes for 2 minutes at 100 BPM.
- 2 Anticipations:** Move the first note of the second measure to the "and of 4" in the first measure (position 8). Instead of landing on beat 1, you arrive early. This single change creates forward motion. Add one anticipation at a time.
- 3 Stops:** The last note before a rest is rhythmically the most important note. Add a "stop" — a note that hits and then is deliberately silenced. The silence after the stop creates space, and the silence is where the groove breathes.
- 4 Clave Sync:** Layer your groove against the 2-3 clave pattern. Your strongest hits should complement (not duplicate) the clave beats. Where the clave is silent, your groove can fill. Where the clave hits, your groove confirms or creates space.

Superstition Clav Pattern Study

The clavinet riff in Superstition is one of the most analyzed grooves in funk history. Its key rhythmic features:

- Strong offbeat feel** — many attacks land on the "ands," not on the downbeats
- 16th-note subdivisions** — the riff lives in the space between beats
- Call-and-response structure** — the riff asks a question; the rest answers
- Minimal left hand** — the left hand provides the Eb7 chord foundation while the right hand riffs
- Damped articulation** — most notes are short (staccato), not held
- Three chord centers:** riff on Eb, lift to Ab, tension to Bb

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Listen to the intro of Superstition (0:00–0:08, just the clav). Clap along with only the *downbeats* (1, 2, 3, 4). Notice how the clav avoids landing directly on your clap. That gap between your clap and the clav attack IS the groove.

S2 — PERFECTING

Hear before you play. Tap the clav rhythm on your lap using the Lap Map (Ch.5). Count the 8-position grid out loud while tapping. Identify which positions are active. Then transfer to your instrument.

S3 — FLUENT

Hear before you play. Play the verse groove (simplified version: Eb7 with anticipation on "and of 4") at 80 BPM without stopping for 2 minutes. Add one stop. Add one anticipation. Keep the groove circular — it should feel like it loops indefinitely.

Guitar: All Inversions on All 4 String Sets

Sprint 4 primary voicing content: triads on every string set, in all three inversions. This is the foundational voicing vocabulary for guitar — Beato pp. 93–100.

WHY STRING SETS MATTER

A **string set** is any group of three adjacent strings. On a standard-tuned guitar there are four three-string sets: strings 6-5-4, strings 5-4-3, strings 4-3-2, and strings 3-2-1. Learning the same triad on all four string sets means you can play any harmony anywhere on the neck without shifting positions.

Each string set has a different voicing spread and register character: the 6-5-4 set sounds *thick and low*; the 3-2-1 set sounds *bright and singing*.

Triad Inversions Review

INVERSION	BOTTOM NOTE	EB MAJOR EXAMPLE	EB MINOR EXAMPLE	CHARACTER
Root position	Root (1)	Eb-Gb-Bb → Eb on bottom	Eb-Gb-Bb → Eb on bottom	Stable, definitive
1st inversion	3rd (3 or b3)	Gb-Bb-Eb → Gb on bottom	Gb-Bb-Eb → Gb on bottom	Lighter, floating
2nd inversion	5th (5)	Bb-Eb-Gb → Bb on bottom	Bb-Eb-Gb → Bb on bottom	Most unstable, wants to move

String Set Shapes — Eb Minor Triad (Eb-Gb-Bb)

Fret positions are illustrative for one voicing per set; multiple positions exist across the neck.

STRINGS 6-5-4 (LOW SET)

Thick, dark voicing. Root position has Eb on string 6 (11th fret). 1st inversion: Gb on string 6 (2nd fret). 2nd inversion: Bb on string 6 (6th fret). Use for rhythm guitar foundation — locks with bass.

STRINGS 5-4-3 (MID-LOW SET)

Warm, full. Root position: Eb on string 5 (6th fret). 1st inversion: Gb on string 5 (9th fret). 2nd inversion: Bb on string 5 (1st fret). Works well for chord melody and chord-soloing.

STRINGS 4-3-2 (MID-HIGH SET)

Clear, mid-range. Root position: Eb on string 4 (1st fret). 1st inversion: Gb on string 4 (4th fret). 2nd inversion: Bb on string 4 (8th fret). Essential for fills and melodic comping.

STRINGS 3-2-1 (HIGH SET)

Bright, singing, cuts through. Root position: Eb on string 3 (8th fret). 1st inversion: Gb on string 3 (11th fret). 2nd inversion: Bb on string 3 (3rd fret). Use for high lead parts and arpeggiated passages.

S1 — DISCOVERING

Hear before you play. Pick one string set (start with 3-2-1). Play the three Eb minor inversions slowly, one after another. Before playing each shape, sing the three notes (Eb, Gb, Bb in some order) out loud. Notice how the same three notes sound different depending on which note is on the bottom.

S2 — PERFECTING

Hear before you play. On one string set, cycle root → 1st → 2nd → root at 60 BPM. Then do the same for Ab minor and Bb minor. Target: all three inversions on two string sets at 80 BPM.

Piano: Dorian Heptachord + Shell Voicing

Eb Dorian Heptachord

All 7 notes stacked: Eb-F-Gb-Ab-Bb-C-Db. LH: Eb-Gb-Bb (triad). RH: Db-Eb-F (top cluster). Play as arpeggios bottom to top. Listen for C natural (raised 6) floating above the minor texture.

Shell Voicing Drill

Shell = root + 3rd + 7th (omit 5th). Eb7: Eb+Gb+Db · Ab7: Ab+C+Gb · Bb7: Bb+D+Ab. Note: Ab7's 3rd is C natural — the Dorian raised-6!

Sprint 4 Quick Reference Card

SUPERSTITION · EB DORIAN · ~100 BPM · ALL CHAMBERS AT A GLANCE

MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER CH.7-9

Ch.7	Interval spelling at keyboard via Pythagorean chain F-C-G-D-A-E-B
Ch.8	8 clefs: treble (G/ln2), bass (F/ln4), soprano C/ln1, mezzo C/ln2, alto C/ln3, tenor C/ln4, baritone C/ln5, percussion (no pitch)
Ch.9	[1]=min2 tense · [3]=min3 modal · [6]=tritone frozen · [7]=P5 stable · [9]=maj6 open · [10]=min7 tense

MELODY CHAMBER

Z1 Sweet	1, 3, 5 = Eb, Gb, Bb
Z2 Bitter	7, 2 = Db, F
Z3 Tense	4 = Ab — long note = maximum tension
Z4 Wild	6 = C (Dorian raised-6)
Duration rule	Long Z3 = strong tension; long Z1 = deep resolution

HARMONY CHAMBER

#1	I-IV-V-I: fundamental cadence
#2	I-V-vi-IV: pop universal
#3	12-Bar Blues: I-I-I-IV-IV-I-I/V-IV-I-V
#4	ii-V-I: jazz drill vehicle (NOT harmonic spine)
#5 preview	vi-IV-I-V (Sprint 5 — What’s Going On)

RHYTHM CHAMBER

3-2 clave	Three-side (pos 1,2,3+) THEN two-side (1,2+)
2-3 clave	Two-side (pos 1,2+) THEN three-side (1,2,3+)
Groove steps	Boring → anticipations → stops → clave sync
Anticipation	Note starts on position 8 (“and of 4”) = pushes
Stop	Last note before rest = most important rhythmically

VOICINGS CHAMBER

4 string sets	6-5-4 (dark) · 5-4-3 (warm) · 4-3-2 (mid) · 3-2-1 (bright)
3 inversions	Root (1 bass) · 1st (3/b3 bass) · 2nd (5 bass)
Shell voicing	Root + 3rd + 7th (no 5th)
Eb7 shell	Eb + Gb + Db
Ab7 shell	Ab + C + Gb (C = Dorian raised-6!)

SUPERSTITION CHEAT SHEET

Key/Mode	Eb Dorian: Eb-F-Gb-Ab-Bb-C-Db
Tonic chord	Eb7 = Eb-Gb-Bb-Db
IV chord	Ab7 = Ab-C-Eb-Gb
V chord	Bb7 = Bb-D-F-Ab
Dorian signal	C natural (raised-6) = bright in minor
Groove feel	2-3 clave, 16th-note offbeats, clav staccato

SPRINT 4 EXIT MILESTONES

- ☐ Interval Spelling: identify any keyboard interval via Pythagorean method <2 sec, no formulas
- ☐ All 8 clefs: can read notes in treble, bass, soprano, mezzo-soprano, alto, tenor, baritone, percussion
- ☐ Di-Chord Numbers: [1]–[7] named + associated with traditional interval name
- ☐ All 4 progressions (#1–#4) on both instruments, including ii-V-I shell voicings in C and G
- ☐ Triad shapes by stringset: guitar — all inversions on 3 string sets at 80 BPM
- ☐ Superstition: verse groove on both instruments, Dorian modal feel established
- ☐ Duration Amplifies Zone: demonstrate long Z3 note (Ab) changing tension vs. long Z1 note (Eb)

SPRINT 5 PREVIEW: WHAT’S GOING ON

Marvin Gaye · Eb major · Plogger Ch.9 complete + Ch.10–11 (Di-Chord pulsation + harmonicity) · Harmony progressions #5–#7 · Zone Distribution Ratios by section · vi-IV-I-V as new primary progression

SPRINT 4 NORTH STAR

“The flat-7 (Db) leans; the raised-6 (C) lifts. Hold the tonic long enough and you don’t need to go anywhere else. That is the whole secret of Dorian.”